

CLASS - 12th

SUBJECT - ENGLISH

PROSE + POETRY + STORY OF ENGLISH

CLASS 12TH BIHAR BOARD – ENGLISH (RAINBOW PART 2)

POETRY CHAPTER 9: SNAKE (BY D.H. LAWRENCE)

 CHAPTER SUMMARY (IN 50 WORDS)

"Snake" is a deeply philosophical and narrative poem composed by D.H. Lawrence. The poet describes an encounter with a venomous golden snake at his water-trough on a hot day. Conflicted between his natural admiration and the societal voice of fear, he regrets throwing a log at the innocent creature.

 12 IMPORTANT SHORT SUBJECTIVE QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

Q1. Why did the poet go to his water-trough on that particular day?

Ans: The poet went to his water-trough with a pitcher to fetch cold water because it was a deeply hot, sweltering July day in Sicily, and he was very thirsty.

Q2. Who was already at the water-trough when the poet arrived?

Ans: A large, long, golden-brown venomous snake was already present at the water-trough, drinking water from the dripping tap before the poet's arrival.

Q3. Why did the poet decide to wait and act like a "second comer"?

Ans: The poet decided to wait because the snake had reached the water-trough before him. Out of respect for nature, he felt he must stand and wait for his turn.

Q4. How did the snake drink water from the trough?

Ans: The snake rested his throat upon the stone bottom, let the water trickle into his slack long body through his straight mouth, and drank softly and quietly.

Q5. What did the "voice of education" or society tell the poet to do?

Ans: The voice of his human education told him that golden-brown snakes in Sicily are highly venomous and dangerous, and therefore he must kill it with a stick.

Q6. What was the inner conflict or dilemma faced by the poet?

Ans: His inner conflict was between his natural admiration for the beautiful, peaceful snake and the societal voice that urged him to be brave and kill the creature.

Q7. How did the poet feel about the snake while it was drinking?



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Ans: The poet felt deeply honored and peaceful. He looked at the snake as a majestic guest who had come from the dark recesses of the earth to drink at his trough.

Q8. What cruel act did the poet commit when the snake started retreating?

Ans: As the snake slowly crawled back into its dark hole, a sudden sense of horror struck the poet. He picked up a clumsy log and threw it at the snake.

Q9. How did the poet feel immediately after throwing the log at the snake?

Ans: The poet felt immediate guilt, shame, and self-reproach. He despised himself and cursed human education for forcing him to attack an innocent creature.

Q10. Why did the poet compare the snake to an "exiled king"?

Ans: He compared the snake to an exiled king because it possessed immense grace, dignity, and majesty, ruling the dark underground world but presently deprived of its crown.

Q11. What is the significance of "Mount Etna" mentioned in the poem?

Ans: Mount Etna is an active volcano in Sicily. Its mention emphasizes the extreme, sweltering volcanic heat of the day, which drove the snake out of the earth.

Q12. What is the central message of D.H. Lawrence in this poem?

Ans: The central message is that modern human education breeds unnecessary hostility toward nature, and we must learn to respect and coexist with primitive living creatures.

 35 OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS (QUESTION & OPTIONS IN SINGLE LINE)

1. 'Snake' is a magnificent and vivid nature poem composed by: (A) Rupert Brooke (B) D.H. Lawrence (C) T.S. Eliot (D) John Keats
2. D.H. Lawrence was an eminent English poet, novelist, and critic born in: (A) 1869 (B) 1885 (C) 1915 (D) 1930
3. Celebrated works of D.H. Lawrence include 'Sons and Lovers' and: (A) Leaves of Grass (B) Lady Chatterley's Lover (C) Drum-Taps (D) Hind Swaraj
4. The poet went to his water-trough carrying a: (A) stick (B) pitcher / jar (C) book (D) gun
5. The climate or weather of the day described in the poem was: (A) freezing cold (B) deeply hot / sweltering (C) rainy (D) windy
6. The entire setting of the poem is based in which Italian island?: (A) Sardinia (B) Sicily (C) Capri (D) Elba
7. The day was incredibly hot due to the smoke and heat of Mount _____. ∴ (A) Vesuvius (B) Etna (C) Fuji (D) Alps
8. The snake came out from the dark secret fissures of the: (A) tree (B) earth-wall (C) river (D) house roof



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9. The poet describes the color of the Sicilian snake as: (A) black (B) golden-brown / earth-brown (C) green (D) bright red
10. The poet stood waiting at the trough because he considered himself a: (A) master (B) second comer (C) thief (D) hunter
11. The snake drank water with its straight mouth from the dripping: (A) river (B) tap (C) bottle (D) rain
12. While drinking, the snake looked around casually like a cattle or a: (A) lion (B) drinking animal / sheep (C) bird (D) ghost
13. The snake flickered its two-forked tongue, which is described as: (A) white (B) black (C) red (D) blue
14. "The voice of my _____ said to me: He must be killed.": (A) mother (B) education / society (C) friend (D) soul
15. In Sicily, black snakes are considered innocent, but golden ones are: (A) holy (B) venomous / deadly (C) small (D) rare
16. "Was it _____, that I dared not kill him?": (A) bravery (B) cowardice (C) wisdom (D) joy
17. The poet states that he felt deeply _____ that the snake had come as a guest.: (A) angry (B) honored / glad (C) terrified (D) sad
18. The snake drank its fill and slowly began to crawl back into a black: (A) box (B) hole / fissure (C) basket (D) river
19. A sudden protest and perversity overcame the poet when the snake was: (A) drinking (B) entering its hole (C) sleeping (D) running away
20. The poet picked up a clumsy _____ and threw it at the water-trough.: (A) stone (B) log / piece of wood (C) iron rod (D) shoe
21. After throwing the log, the poet felt immediate: (A) happiness (B) regret and shame (C) pride (D) fear
22. The poet despised himself and cursed the voices of his human: (A) books (B) education (C) friends (D) laws
23. The poet wished that the beautiful snake would: (A) die (B) come back / reappear (C) attack him (D) vanish forever
24. The poet compares the snake to an exiled king of the: (A) forest (B) underworld / dark earth (C) sea (D) skies
25. The poet felt that he had missed a great chance of interacting with a king of: (A) wealth (B) lord of life / nature (C) power (D) weapons
26. The tree mentioned in the poem under whose shade the trough sat was a: (A) mango tree (B) carob -tree (C) banyan tree (D) pine tree
27. The snake moved its body smoothly, looking similar to a: (A) rope (B) snake / fluid line (C) stick (D) chain



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28. The vocabulary used to describe the snake gives it an image of supreme: (A) cruelty (B) dignity and majesty (C) weakness (D) anger
29. D.H. Lawrence's nature poems heavily reflect his love for the: (A) machinery (B) primitive and raw life (C) big cities (D) politics
30. The poem 'Snake' is written beautifully in: (A) rhyming stanzas (B) free verse (C) sonnet structure (D) blank verse
31. The term 'flickered' in the text stands for a rapid, back-and-forth: (A) sleeping (B) movement of the tongue (C) walking (D) shouting
32. The snake did not show any signs of initial _____ towards the poet.: (A) friendship (B) fear or hostility (C) love (D) gratitude
33. The act of throwing the log is described by the poet as a petty and _____ act.: (A) brave (B) vulgar / mean (C) heroic (D) wise
34. The poet compares his behavior to the famous ancient mariner who shot the: (A) eagle (B) albatross (C) lion (D) deer
35. The poem leaves the reader with a deep reflection on our moral debt to the animal: (A) trade (B) kingdom / world (C) sports (D) history

SUJIT KUMAR

